

Opus 5.5 Migration Checklist

Everything to check before you swap `claude-opus-5` for `claude-opus-5-5`. Four breaking changes, two silent ones, and a few habits that save you later. On Claude Managed Agents? Only the model name changes.

*Swap one model ID = 4 breaking changes
+ 2 that change silently. Check first.*

1. Before swapping the model ID

- ☐ Shortcut: in Claude Code, run `/claude-api migrate this project to claude-opus-5-5`.
Anthropic's bundled skill swaps the model ID, applies the breaking changes, and gives you a checklist to verify by hand.
- ☐ Search your code for `thinking: {"type": "disabled"} or "enabled"` with `budget_tokens`.
Both now return a 400. Remove them and set `output_config.effort` instead.
- ☐ Search for `tool_choice` set to `"any"` or `"tool"`.
Forced tool use returns a 400. Use `"auto"` with strict tool use or structured outputs. Strict tool use needs `additionalProperties: false` on every object in the schema.
- ☐ Using the `computer_20251124` computer use tool on the Claude API or Google Cloud?
It's rejected there. Migrate to `computer_toolset_20260801`. Amazon Bedrock still accepts the old tool.

2. Silent changes (no error)

- ☐ Set effort explicitly.
The default dropped from high (Opus 5) to medium. Omit it and you're quietly running a different setup.
- ☐ Re-run your effort tests.
Opus 5.5 thinks more per turn at the same level. Leave headroom in `max_tokens`; at xhigh or max effort, start at 64k.
- ☐ Re-baseline cost and latency at your chosen effort.
Thinking tokens are billed as output even when the thinking text isn't returned.
- ☐ Showing progress updates between tool calls?
That text now arrives in thinking blocks, empty by default, so your UI goes quiet. Set `thinking.display` to `"updates"` (beta header `thinking-display-updates-2026-08-18`) or `"summarized"`, then render the non-empty thinking blocks.

3. Code hygiene

- ☐ Pick response blocks by type, not position.
Responses can start with thinking blocks, so `content[0].text` breaks.
- ☐ Pass thinking blocks back unmodified in tool-use loops.
Edited, reordered, or partially dropped thinking blocks are rejected with a 400.
- ☐ Keep conversations append-only.
On accounts created on or after Aug 31, 2026, replaying an old thinking block after changing the system prompt, tools, or an earlier message returns a 400. Change instructions with mid-conversation system messages instead of edits.
- ☐ Switching models mid-conversation?
Some models can't read other models' thinking blocks, so that reasoning gets dropped.

4. Safeguards

- ☐ Expect new refusal categories.

Besides "cyber", `stop_details.category` can now be "bio" or "reasoning_extraction".

- ☐ Handle refusals.

They return HTTP 200 with `stop_reason: "refusal"`. Configure a fallback, but note server-side fallback won't retry `reasoning_extraction` refusals.

5. Before production traffic

- ☐ Re-evaluate prompt instructions tuned for Opus 5.

Some may no longer be needed on Opus 5.5.

- ☐ Test in a development environment before switching production traffic.

6. Bonus: cost

- ☐ Pricing: \$4 input / \$20 output per million tokens (Opus 5 was \$5 / \$25).

- ☐ Cache reads cost 0.05x the base input price (\$0.20 per million).

- ☐ Batch processing is half price (\$2 / \$10).

*Sonnet 5.5 + Haiku 5.5 are expected soon.
Follow @gouravkargwal for the breakdowns.*

Source: Anthropic's "What's new in Claude Opus 5.5" docs and migration guide (platform.claude.com), checked Sep 25, 2026. Confirm there before migrating.